

Reading

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Our Neighbours in Space

Before you read

- Look at the title. What planets do you think this text will mention?
- What do you already know about our solar system?

Our solar system has eight planets that orbit the Sun. Some, like Mercury and Venus, are close to the Sun and extremely hot. Others, like Neptune and Uranus, are far away and freezing cold. Earth sits in a special zone where the temperature is just right for liquid water, and that is one reason life exists here.

Mars is often called the 'Red Planet' because of the iron dust on its surface. Scientists are very interested in Mars because they believe it once had rivers and lakes. If future missions find clear signs of water underground, researchers will search even harder for signs of past or present life. Several robotic rovers have already explored the surface, sending back photos and data.

Jupiter, the largest planet, is a giant ball of gas with a famous storm called the Great Red Spot. It does not have a solid surface, so astronauts could never land on it. Saturn is easy to recognise because of its beautiful rings, made of ice and rock. Both planets have many moons, and some of these moons, like Europa and Enceladus, may have oceans hidden under thick ice.

Space agencies around the world continue to plan new missions. If governments and companies keep investing in space technology, humans will probably visit Mars within the next few decades. Until then, telescopes and robotic explorers remain our best way to learn about our fascinating neighbours in space.

1. Why is Earth in a special zone in the solar system?

- a. It is the closest planet to the Sun.
- b. It has a temperature right for liquid water.
- c. It has rings made of ice and rock.
- d. It is the largest planet.

2. Why is Mars called the 'Red Planet'?

- a. Because of storms on its surface.
- b. Because it is close to the Sun.
- c. Because of iron dust on its surface.
- d. Because of its rings.

3. According to the text, astronauts could land on the surface of Jupiter. — *True / False*

4. Saturn is easy to recognise because of its _____.

5. What does the text say may happen if investment in space technology continues?

- a. Mars missions will stop.
- b. Humans will probably visit Mars within decades.
- c. Jupiter will get a solid surface.
- d. Saturn's rings will disappear.

6. Which moons are mentioned as possibly having hidden oceans?

- a. Titan and Triton
- b. Europa and Enceladus
- c. Phobos and Deimos
- d. Io and Callisto

After you read

- Which planet in the text do you find the most interesting, and why?
- Do you think humans will live on Mars one day? Why or why not?

Are We Alone in the Universe?

Before you read

- Do you think there is life on other planets? Why or why not?
- What would happen if scientists found alien life?

For centuries, people have wondered whether life exists beyond Earth. Scientists now use powerful telescopes to search for planets outside our solar system, called exoplanets. If a planet is the right distance from its star and has water, scientists consider it a good place to look for life.

So far, no one has found clear proof of alien life. However, researchers have discovered thousands of exoplanets, and some of them are similar in size to Earth. A project called SETI (Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence) listens for radio signals from space, hoping to detect a message from another civilisation. If SETI ever receives a real signal, it will be one of the most important discoveries in human history.

Some scientists focus closer to home. They study Mars, and the icy moons of Jupiter and Saturn, because simple forms of life, like bacteria, might survive there. If future missions bring back samples from these places, laboratories on Earth will test them carefully for any sign of life.

Many people find the question exciting rather than frightening. Finding even simple microbial life beyond Earth would completely change how humans see their place in the universe. Until that day comes, scientists continue to search, explore, and imagine what — or who — might be out there.

1. What is an exoplanet?

- a. A moon of Saturn
- b. A planet outside our solar system
- c. A type of telescope
- d. A radio signal

2. SETI stands for Search for _____ Intelligence.

3. Scientists have already found clear proof of alien life. — True / False

4. Where else, besides exoplanets, do scientists look for possible life?

AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 10. Sınıf — Reading · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

- a. Only on the Moon
- b. Mars and the icy moons of Jupiter and Saturn
- c. Only on Venus
- d. Only inside our galaxy's stars

5. What will happen if SETI receives a real signal, according to the text?

- a. It will be ignored.
- b. It will be one of the most important discoveries in history.
- c. Scientists will stop searching.
- d. It will prove aliens do not exist.

After you read

- Do you think humans will ever find proof of alien life? Explain your answer.
- How do you think people would react if scientists found life on another planet?